

SENATE CHAMBER

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

DISPOSITION

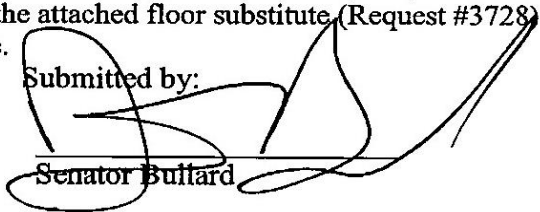
☒ FLOOR AMENDMENT

No. 1

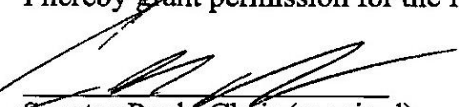
☐ COMMITTEE AMENDMENT

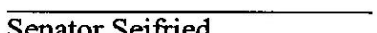
I move to amend Senate Bill No. 1237, by substituting the attached floor substitute (Request #3728) for the title, enacting clause, and entire body of the measure. (Date)

Submitted by:


Senator Bullard

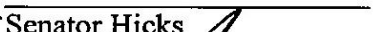
I hereby grant permission for the floor substitute to be adopted.

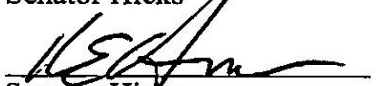

Senator Pugh, Chair (required)

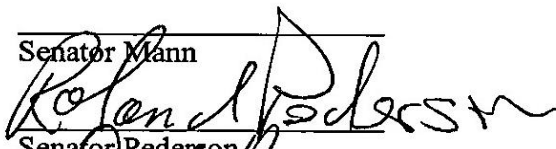

Senator Seifried

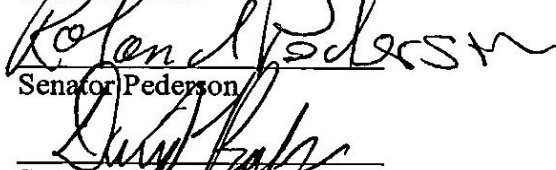

Senator Dossett


Senator Deever

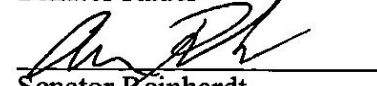

Senator Hicks

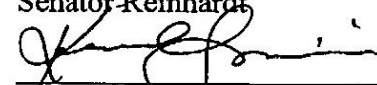

Senator Hines


Senator Mann


Senator Pederson


Senator Rader


Senator Reinhardt


Senator Sascheri

Senator Paxton, President Pro Tempore

Senator Daniels, Majority Floor
Leader

Note: Education committee majority requires six (6) members' signatures.

Bullard-EB-FS-SB1237
2/23/2026 2:19 PM

(Floor Amendments Only)

Date and Time Filed: 3/4/26

1:53pm 

☐ Untimely

☐ Amendment Cycle Extended

☐ Secondary Amendment

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

FLOOR SUBSTITUTE

FOR

SENATE BILL NO. 1237

By: Bullard of the Senate

and

Hays of the House

FLOOR SUBSTITUTE

An Act relating to teachers; creating the Teachers' Bill of Rights; providing short title; affording certain rights to certain teachers, administrators, and support staff; directing creation of certain due process plan; requiring plan to include certain components; providing for codification; providing an effective date; and declaring an emergency.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 6-101.9 of Title 70, unless there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

A. This act shall be known and may be cited as the "Teachers' Bill of Rights".

B. Teachers, administrators, and support staff employed by a school district, public charter school, or public virtual charter school in this state shall be afforded the following rights:

1 1. The right to free expression of religion, speech, and
2 peaceable assembly including, but not limited to:

- 3 a. the right to keep the Holy Scriptures in their
4 classrooms for personal use,
- 5 b. the right to use the Hebrew Scriptures and the New
6 Testament as they pertain to the teaching of American
7 history or American literature if presented
8 objectively as part of a secular program of education,
- 9 c. the right to wear faith-based or religious symbols
10 including jewelry on their persons,
- 11 d. the right to pray with, over, or in front of students
12 as provided for in Section 11-101.1 of Title 70 of the
13 Oklahoma Statutes, and
- 14 e. the right to a working environment in which the
15 employing school district, public charter school, or
16 public virtual charter school does not endorse, favor,
17 demean, show hostility toward, or intentionally
18 undermine any particular religion or nonreligious
19 faith or religious perspective;

20 2. The right to be free from the use of vulgar or abusive
21 language by students and other teachers, administrators, or support
22 staff;

23 3. The right to be free from physical harm or threats from
24 students, parents or legal guardians of students, and other

1 employees of the school district, public charter school, or public
2 virtual charter school;

3 4. The right to provide for the control and discipline of
4 students as may be assigned to him or her and to keep good order in
5 the classroom and other places in which he or she is assigned to be
6 in charge of students including:

7 a. the right to have disobedient, disrespectful, violent,
8 abusive, or disruptive students removed from the
9 classroom,

10 b. the right to refuse to allow a student who has been
11 suspended for a violent offense to return to his or
12 her classroom, as provided for in Section 24-101.3 of
13 Title 70 of the Oklahoma Statutes, and

14 c. the right to use established and reasonable methods of
15 discipline, as provided for in the policy adopted
16 pursuant to Section 24-100.4 of Title 70 of the
17 Oklahoma Statutes, and to be immune from civil
18 liability for any action taken in good faith as
19 provided for Section 24-101.3 of Title 70 of the
20 Oklahoma Statutes;

21 5. The right of designated school personnel to carry and use a
22 firearm, as provided for in Section 5-149.2 of Title 70 of the
23 Oklahoma Statutes;

1 6. The right to a safe working environment with adequate safety
2 protocols and structural safety measures to ensure protection from
3 exterior or interior threats of violence;

4 7. The right to medical privacy, to refuse a vaccination as a
5 condition of employment, and to refuse to wear a mask or any other
6 medical device as a condition of employment, except as provided for
7 in Section 1210.190 of Title 70 of the Oklahoma Statutes;

8 8. The right to refuse to provide instruction or participate in
9 training on any topic that violates the individual's conscience,
10 ethics, or religion; provided, however, the individual shall be
11 prohibited from refusing to provide instruction prescribed by state
12 law including the subject matter standards provided for in Section
13 11-103.6 of Title 70 of the Oklahoma Statutes or prescribed by State
14 Board of Education rules;

15 9. The right to adequate planning time including at least one
16 (1) hour per day not to be infringed by additional responsibilities
17 or requests; provided, however, an individual may voluntarily
18 relinquish his or her planning hour;

19 10. The right to a lunch period of a minimum of twenty (20)
20 minutes during the school day;

21 11. The right to information regarding complaints filed by a
22 student or the parent or legal guardian of a student, unless the
23 complaint is part of a law enforcement investigation;

1 12. The right to be protected by school administrators when
2 helping students better understand, analyze, critique, and review in
3 an objective manner the strengths and weaknesses of existing
4 theories, issues, and subjects which may be controversial when
5 covered in a course being taught using evidence-based, peer-reviewed
6 material; and

7 13. The right to privately petition a school administrator, a
8 school district board of education, or a governing body of a public
9 charter school or public virtual charter school to modify a school
10 policy.

11 C. A school district board of education or the governing body
12 of a public charter school or public virtual charter school shall
13 create a due process plan for teachers, administrators, and support
14 staff to report violations of the rights provided for in subsection
15 B of this section. The due process plan shall include, at a
16 minimum, the following:

17 1. Designation of a school employee or employees to receive
18 reports of violation;

19 2. Provisions for anonymous reports to protect the identity of
20 the accuser from retribution;

21 3. A requirement that reported violations be investigated by
22 designated school employees in a timely manner;

23 4. Procedures for investigating and implementing punishment for
24 false accusations;

1 5. Procedures for reporting to law enforcement suspected
2 violations that may constitute criminal activity or reasonably have
3 the potential to endanger school safety; and

4 6. A procedure for appealing findings of a designated school
5 employee or employees to a school district board of education or the
6 governing body of a public charter school or public virtual charter
7 school.

8 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

9 SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
10 of the public peace, health, or safety, an emergency is hereby
11 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
12 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

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14 60-2-3728 EB 3/4/2026 3:04:37 PM

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